

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] All right, so. See. Right. So let's get to it. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:12] [15-20].

Speaker 1 [00:00:13] [15-20]. And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:20] We're coming up on [month(s)].

Speaker 1 [00:00:25] And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:28] [We do or do not].

Speaker 1 [00:00:31] And who lives in the household.

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] Oh, we're. [dog]. And now she's up there. I'm living with [parents].

Speaker 1 [00:00:46] Okay. Separately. And what is your main source of income and your current job? Around like range.

Speaker 2 [00:01:01] I work for [work] as well.

Speaker 1 [00:01:08] Thank. All right. And main source of income. Like. Is that your main source of income? I mean.

Speaker 2 [00:01:20] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:01:21] Okay. Got it. All right. And how would you like me to address your partner? Partner? Lover or girlfriend?

Speaker 2 [00:01:36] Partners are.

Speaker 1 [00:01:37] Different. All right. So from now on, it's just a couple of questions regarding your love story and such. So feel free to talk as much as you want, and I'll be just taking notes. Right. So first question is, can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:02:02] Um, I think between us, we've. Like we've always been a part of the same friend group in high school, something was always kind of there like a. Like a type of blessing feeling. But. There's this kind of like a like a social rule that people within certain groups don't start like getting together and stuff. So. I think we are both kind of simultaneously. Blocking out any type of. Attraction towards each other. Until. You know, you graduate high school like friend groups. Don't normally laugh. It just left it. It got left with just us two. And then immediately there, just. A bunch of. Well seemed like newfound feelings. But we both agreed that we think that they were always there. And. At the same time, we just decided that it felt right to be together now that there was a. Like that social rule kind of floating over our heads and kind of. Determining what we were going to do with ourselves.

Speaker 1 [00:03:34] All right. And you had mentioned high school. Was that when you met?

Speaker 2 [00:03:43] Yeah, well, we've known of each other since middle school, but we didn't start talking to. We didn't start interacting until [1-5 years] . But it I would say we truly met in high school. We have actually met each other [year].

Speaker 1 [00:04:09] I see. What do you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:04:25] It just feels more. The best. The best term I can use to describe it is like. Is like that type of old love. Like it's. It's just like stronger doesn't feel as immature as we really are. Like age. Um. It just. Compared to the other relationships around me and of my peers. That just doesn't seem very. They're not very involved like. We? There's just a. I see my friends relationships as somebody that they were just infatuated with and, you know, they're having fun experimenting, like seeing what there is for casual. For me and my partner. Just. It kind of goes back to how we always kind of felt like we were supposed to be with each other. And it was no, it was no coincidence. And it's. More like feelings are stronger. They seem more real. Maybe that's just because. I'm thinking from my own perspective, and I'm sure everybody might feel the same way, but. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:06:12] Great. All right. So. Can I ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:06:21] Yeah. Three, not including her. Currently.

Speaker 1 [00:06:34] And now how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:06:45] Um, a lot of it just has to do with. How much you change as a person, as a as a youth. And. Like. There was. I wasn't. I wasn't capable of even knowing what it was. To love somebody. When I was [16-20], which was the last. The last time I was in a previous relationship. It's just this. This relationship feels like. Everything I was romanticizing before, but. Actually materialized and is a real thing. So it's nice. Want to. And. And before I was just like my previous partner is kind of dating just dating them because you had like. A mutual physical attraction and there's not actually a connection going on. The fact that I knew my current partner for a while before being with her, much like the more heavily established. Like nothing is new. We already knew each other, and now we get to know each other in a way that. That we wanted. The whole time. It's just there's there's there's more of a connection going on, more of a draw towards each other than just. Like physical or pretend infatuation.

Speaker 1 [00:08:53] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:08:55] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:08:57] All right. And for you, what makes a relationship high quality and low quality.

Speaker 2 [00:09:09] Let's see. To me a high quality relationship. There's. One that can have adaptiveness. One. One that can. Where two individuals can change their feelings toward each other and never do. Or. For us, it's just being able to be your most vulnerable form of self and not feel like you ever have to alter who you are around somebody else. And. A bad quality relationship is one where. You have to pretend to be the person. That. Put in the words and. The person that you think. They want you to be. And you're always

conforming yourself and like, meddling with yourself to try to. Conform to a fictional being because your. Trying to just always change yourself into. Do you think your partner wants you to be? It's just never healthy. I consider that bad quality one where you don't have to where you or your partner never have to. Feel like they're walking on eggshells when it comes to their interactions with you or or with yourself and just who you are. This. Where who you are the most vulnerable form of us. The one that we don't show to the world. Is the version of us that you can share with them and. It's okay.

Speaker 1 [00:11:38] Okay. All right. So. You kind of touched on this a bit, but what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:06] Love. After the long day. Pretty universal answer. But it's true. If you don't have trust, you really don't have a. Vulnerability, the ability to be vulnerable. I think a lot of people downplay it nowadays, but just attraction and sex life is. It's very important because very it's tied in with our like, our biology. And your emotions and your serotonin and whatever, all kind of chemicals react a certain way. They completely change your. Thought processes of your feelings. But you. It's kind of looked over a lot because it seems it seems shallow, I guess, but I really don't think it is this. That's really important. Never. Just. It's somebody. You're okay with this? It's important to. If you're with somebody where you feel like your life can turn into a partnership with somebody else. And how you are living.

Speaker 1 [00:14:08] Mhm. Right. And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:14:24] I think it's just. Something that everybody undeniably needs. It just never needs. It's like it's the one thing. That we don't need a reason for. Because it's the drive behind everything. If you don't have love for something or somebody. Then there's never any. It's. It's the reason. It's the only reason any of us are here or have or move forward in any area. You can apply love to all of it. And it's just a. You can umbrella it and put it behind any reason that anything is happening. It's the. The hard question to answer is just one of the most. Inexplicable things that we experience. Or whatever it may be. Very real, very strong effects of. More than anything else. It's what? The. It's just that I think, well, that's just the reason for everything. Like if you need to find a reason for anything. You know, you don't know what it is. You can somehow apply. You can somehow apply. Whatever its definition may be. Do it.

Speaker 1 [00:17:03] Yeah. So you said it is a drive for everything and it is basically an umbrella reason for multiple things, but it is real strong and affects humans more than anything else.

Speaker 2 [00:17:21] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:17:22] But what is? What? What exactly is love for you, if that makes sense? Like, what does love do for you specifically?

Speaker 2 [00:17:36] Okay. Um. Loving and feeling was. Is just. They're just like. Main reason to be content is it's really hard to quit. It's really hard to give an answer to a question because, like, I know, like I know what it is. But I feel like there's so much to say and, like, don't know where to.

Speaker 1 [00:19:06] Yeah, that's. That's completely fine. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:19:10] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:19:12] That's completely all right. So moving on. How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:21] Is a good. And.

Speaker 1 [00:19:24] How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:33] Well, I mean, it's. It's the most important thing. If. If you don't have love a relationship, then. Really? You mean you would end up being absent of each other? And it's. It's love that the reason is like two people are like, stay together. So I think it's the most it's the most important aspect of a relationship. More importantly, yes, every time you tell somebody, I love you, it's. It's like. You have an impact on my being. And like and everything I feel. To a much further extent than. Um. Yeah. It's the most important part.

Speaker 1 [00:20:56] Yeah. How do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:10] Um. I know that my partner loves me. When, they go out of. They'll go out of their own way. For. Express it to me by any means. Like they like. They drop whatever else they could be doing. That also benefits yourself. Do you know I'm going to. I'm going to come see you this weekend, for example. Like, whatever. I know that there are so many other more. Maybe productive things could be going on whenever somebody whenever they go out of their way. Entirely. It was me that. I mean, something to them.

Speaker 1 [00:22:14] Okay. What would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:27] He. Distance is a challenge for sure. And we also. We both have a tendency like part of our personality. The. It may be a fear of being attacked, but it's it's very hard to. Let the wall down and be vulnerable and just talk about feelings. It's hard for both of us. And that's a challenge because. You can. You can create conflict that way, you know, like DUIs. But feelings bottle up a lot. And then. Sometimes you get flipped and it just. Eruption is something we need to be with. Really all we did. All we need to do is. Learn to. Learn to lean on each other a lot more and feel okay with it. No.

Speaker 1 [00:24:02] Oh, sorry. I was muted. My next question is, do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:24:14] I would say no. We've had conflicts with each other. Like. Where our vulgar verbal tones, when each other starts to change a little bit. You know, it gets passionate for sure, but I don't that's not really my definition of fighting because there's still something to work towards. Whenever we're having a passionate disagreement, we're still working towards something, a solution where I think fighting is. You're just. You're just going to kind of go at it and you're not. And it's for nothing, really. I wouldn't say we do.

Speaker 1 [00:25:10] Okay. What are other ways you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:23] Making an effort to talk on the phone unless you can be sure this. I send her stuff in the mail. I was. Yeah, like reminders. Like I'm still here, so care. Um. Making sure that she doesn't ask herself. I don't want her to start asking yourself why over. I want her to already know. So I just I try to kind of keep it up to date. Like, remind her why. Remind her why we're together in the first place. I think it's important.

Speaker 1 [00:26:17] Okay. And would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:26:31] It is because. It. Because I think I can stay happy if I always have something to look forward to. And my partner always gives me something to look forward to. For me going on vacation, experiencing anything with them. Really? Just being around. It gives me something to look forward to. What if I'm not? If I wasn't in this relationship. I. Would. Really just start wondering why I do any of the things that I do because I'm just like, I'm just working to what I'd be working towards. Blessed living to look forward to less things to come. And it brings a huge benefit for me and always like. Have something positive that's going to come up in the foreseeable future. And to just feel. Just feel cared about. When you're alone. Well, when I'm alone. It's for long enough. I start to. Question of. Anybody care? Like if anybody cares about like. If anybody loves me, I know people because I know people care. But I like somebody that loves me the way that my partner does. It's very validating to my existence.

Speaker 1 [00:28:37] Could you provide an example?

Speaker 2 [00:28:44] Yeah. Like being single. Before I was with her, I really didn't know why I was doing any of the things that I do. I would. Because it's. Not quite enough because doing something to move forward was never really quite enough. To satisfy myself. For myself. Like if I. Was. By if I made my room look really nice or. Saved up some money or like little things. It's like just the question of what pops up at the end of it. A lot more. It gives little things like that. A lot more of a reason if. If life partners go into. Experience it also.

Speaker 1 [00:30:22] You did. You did say a couple things, but did the relationship change you and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:30:38] Actually, no. It didn't change me for who I am. And I'm still the same. I'm the same person. I was. Before being with my partner and.

Speaker 1 [00:31:00] Hey. What about your partner? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:31:14] I don't think so. The. So part of those changes, his newfound love for each other. But we're the same people that we knew before we were in a romantic relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:31:37] All right. Okay. So next question. Do you feel safe in the relationship? And why do you say so? And this can be physical or emotional. And or.

Speaker 2 [00:32:21] Emotionally so safe because. Um. Hello. Hello. Okay. I am going to be judged for feeling the way that I do. Or for having emotions at all? At all. Emotionally, I feel safe. Because. I can tell them how. I can tell them how I'm feeling without fear of disapproval or some kind of or biting back at me somehow.

Speaker 1 [00:33:08] All right. And these next couple of questions are part of a Likert scale. So first question from one. Not at all true to nine. Completely true. If I were to ask my partner, he usually really listens to me. What would you answer?

Speaker 2 [00:33:42] [5-10].

Speaker 1 [00:33:49] All right. And. What about if I were to ask? My partner usually is responsive to my needs. From 1 to 10. I mean from 1 to 9.

Speaker 2 [00:34:28] The same [5-10].

Speaker 1 [00:34:34] Why did you answer seven for the first question in terms of your. My partner usually really listens to me. And can you give me concrete examples? In other words, why seven and not 8 or 6?

Speaker 2 [00:35:07] Okay. Because. Whenever we, uh, are having a disagreement. Um. A wall of defense. We usually get put up pretty quick. You will listen to me. Of 2 or 7 likable or like. I would like seven in particular because. You listen to me If I'm feeling a certain type of way without conflict. At a nine. But whenever we're disagreeing with each other and there's a reason to defend ourselves. Then. It's the listening aspect for my partner goes down like 5 or 6. So I just kind of fell in the middle.

Speaker 1 [00:36:37] All right. And for the other question, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. Given nine. Why did you choose nine and why not eight?

Speaker 2 [00:36:59] Because she exceeds. My. My needs. He goes beyond whatever it is I think that I need. She'll take care of it. And then some. Pretty much all the time. Like. Will do something for me that I didn't. I didn't think I would even appreciate before that kind of thing.

Speaker 1 [00:37:47] Yeah. All right. And I hope you don't mind if I ask. And feel free to say if it's too sensitive for you to share. But I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. You had mentioned that the sex lives and intimacy is. Let me go back here. It is important for love and in a relationship. Great. And you have to say, if you don't want to answer the questions, are you comfortable with that?

Speaker 2 [00:38:34] Yeah, that's a lot of questions.

Speaker 1 [00:38:36] Okay. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:38:47] Uh. When we see each other once every [1-5] weeks. So. Yeah. Twice a month.

Speaker 1 [00:39:09] Okay. And just one more question on that topic. How satisfied are you with your sex life and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:39:23] And I'm satisfied. Very satisfied because we. Because we both pay attention to what's important to one another during times of intimacy and take note of it and. There's a lot of. And I just. I have that feeling of connection. Like, it's a lot more important whenever I love the person that I'm being intimate with. Very satisfied because of the love that's involved and because of the. Effort that gets put into it on both ends.

Speaker 1 [00:40:16] All right. Moving on. In general, how satisfied are you with your relationship? From completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:40:33] Is this like one of the one through nine ones or.

Speaker 1 [00:40:39] Kind of, but without numbers. So completely dissatisfied or maybe dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, Unsure or neutral. Somewhat satisfied. Very satisfied. Or completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:40:59] Completely. We're very, very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:41:11] Right. And why? Very satisfied and not completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:41:19] Bolling Because there's still things that we still have to learn about each other. And. Some things are kind of up in the air for sure. We're still figuring each other out. it hasn't even been [1-5] months of being in it. We've known each other for. [1-5] years and some change, but like, we didn't know what it was like to be in a romantic relationship with each other. There's still just a lot to be learned. So I, I, I don't feel like I can say completely.

Speaker 1 [00:42:00] Okay. All right. Did your relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:42:19] Yeah. Yeah, I did. And as.

Speaker 1 [00:42:30] The. So we are close to wrapping up. And I would just like to summarize what we have talked about for the past hour.

Speaker 2 [00:42:40] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:42:42] So you're [15-20] years old. You have been together for [1-5] months but have known each other for around [1-5] years. You have [0-5] children. You're living separately and long distance. And. From your love story. You're from the same friend group. And there was like. I guess you can say a stigma of dating friends. So that's what kind of prevented you guys from becoming a thing until school graduation and feelings were you decided that or you guys decided that feelings were always there and that's when you decided to get together after not having that, like, social role and. Right. And in terms of the quality of the relationship compared to your friend's relationship, you said that it feels more like old love. So stronger, mature, more involved and real. And your friends relationships are more of experimentation and infatuation. And you have had. [1-5] romantic partners in the past, not including your current relationship right now. I know. Oh. All right. And this relationship. Is more. Compared to the so the past relationships. Were you determined that were less? Of quality because you have changed as a person. You said that you were incapable of knowing what love is or what it's like to love someone truly. And what you romanticize basically came true to realize with their current relationship. Back then, you didn't just to date because of physical and not of a true connection that you were able to distinguish now with this current relationship. And. And be with your current partner for longer or knowing them for longer. Pretty much establish the connection that you guys feel now. And you said in terms of high quality and low quality, high quality can be determined by adeptness where two people change. Oh, and also where if of a possibility that two people change their feelings, do stay the same, they're able to be vulnerable and feeling like. And feeling okay with being vulnerable and also not changing for others and for low quality, you said. Where you kind of have to pretend to be the person that you want. You believe the partner wants you to be. So, in other words, kind of like walking in eggshells and not being true to yourself. And then. For the question. The most important thing or the most important things in a relationship. You said trust for vulnerability and. Attraction and sex life. And then for your definition of what is love, you

describe that it is a need without reason, because it is a drive for everything. And it is an umbrella of reason for multiple things. It is real strong and affects humans more than anything else. And loving and sharing. Love is your reason to be content. For how important love is in a relationship. You said that it is the most important because without it. Because in general, without it, a couple would be okay with the absence of each other or having no reason to stay together. And. And for how, you know, your partner loves you is that they go out of their own way to express love to you in any means, and they drop things that benefit them for you. So there is the app for. And some challenges are distance and also the tendency to or fear of being attached or just not being or the fear of being vulnerable. And you mentioned that that's you guys is personality. You guys tend to bottle up feelings and. But you're learning to lean on each other and be okay with it. You said there are no fights, that there are conflicts, and you're able to distinguish it by verbal tones. But. Instead of actually being off by. Or how you how you define a fly is when there is no direction while having like some conflicts. Is you working toward something with your partner? In other words, that you maintain your relationship. You're making an effort to talk on the phone due to the distance. You send mail there expressing that you're still there for her and making sure that there's no doubt of the love that you guys have.

Speaker 2 [00:49:19] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:49:20] Also. You said that the relationship is good for you because. You can stay happy. And because she gives you something to look forward to and if you weren't to be in a relationship. Even specifically with her, you would wonder why you do things in general. And just being in a relationship brings benefits to. Brings benefits and brings kind of like a positive light towards pretty much anything you do. So. If you happen to be alone and if you weren't in the relationship you were, you would question if anyone loves you even though you care. Is there. In the light, in other words. Yeah. And it's melody and. Oh, yeah. And you weren't satisfied before meeting her, but now. You are. And it gives more reason to experience love. And said that the relationship didn't change either of you. And you feel. Safe in the relationship. Also, You rated from 1 to 9 for My partner usually really listens to you. A seven because. When there are disagreements, there are some defenses and both sides and. When there is a conflict, but without a conflict, it is a nine and from around like 5 to 6 when conflict is on both sides. And. For the question or the statement, my partner usually is responsive to my need to read it. And nine because she goes beyond. All the time and does things for you that you wouldn't have appreciated before. Also. You see each other [1-5] a week and around that time. I mean.

Speaker 2 [00:51:52] [1-5] a month.

Speaker 1 [00:51:53] Every [1-5] weeks. Every [1-5] weeks in my bed. Yeah. [1-5] a month. And around that time is when you guys would have sex. And you're very satisfied with it. As you pay attention to each other's needs and take note of it. And what enhances it is feelings of connection and love and effort on both ends. And overall, you're very satisfied because there are. Yeah, you're very satisfied and not completely satisfied because there is still room for growth and you're still figuring each other out. Considering that you guys have been together for [1-5] months.

Speaker 2 [00:52:34] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:52:35] And. And, yeah, the relationship fulfills your expectations. All right. Is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:52:48] Nope.

Speaker 1 [00:52:51] Got it. All right. So thank you so much. And now before we end, I want to talk to you about how we handle the data as a research project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible. So we want I wanted or we the whole research wants you to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with. And based on, let me pull it up. Based on the screenshot you said, you said that you consent to having the interview audio recorded and you're comfortable with the data sharing option of full transcript except sensitive details that can be shared. Would you like to change any options in that or are you okay with that still?

Speaker 2 [00:53:47] Of the. The part that I signed said it's a full transcript except for sensitive details.

Speaker 1 [00:53:57] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:53:59] That's all I signed. Actually, that was probably my mistake. I didn't mean to. I'm fine with a full transcript in general, including sensitive topics.

Speaker 1 [00:54:13] Okay. Got it. All right. And yeah, so thank you so much again for participating in the study. And I would like for you to know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and the US. So this is the US segment. And for this study to be successful, there's also one more thing that we will like to ask you and if that's okay for you, could you recommend people to people in your life as a nominator? And we would ask them for additional couples that might be interested in the study. More like a domino effect, if that makes sense.

Speaker 2 [00:54:53] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:54:54] And yeah, we'll be asking them for couples that you don't know or interact with. And this way we can get as diverse a network as we can get. And is that okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:55:08] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:55:10] All right. And feel free to send, like, the information of that couple. Once you think of it through email, you get the same email threat. So, yeah, so thank you. And we'll be contacting them either today or tomorrow. And we'll also be grateful if you could give them a heads up so they don't block us when we contact them. Yeah. So thank you so much and have a good night.

Speaker 2 [00:55:38] All right. You too. Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:55:41] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:55:41] Bye bye.